

Budgeting for Beginners - Printable Worksheets

From *Budgeting for Beginners* by Thomas Ashcroft (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need. Chapter references are to the book.

Worksheet 1 - The Monthly Budget

Income (take-home)	Monthly
Pay 1 (after tax, insurance, retirement)	
Pay 2	
Other regular income (benefits, pension, side income after costs)	
Total take-home (A)	

Essentials (target about 50 per cent of A)	Tracked month	Plan
Rent or mortgage (with tax and insurance)		
Utilities (electricity, gas, water, rubbish)		
Internet and phone		
Groceries		
Transport (fuel, transit, parking, car payment)		
Car insurance		
Health insurance and medicines		
Other insurance		
Minimum debt payments (Worksheet		

3)		
Childcare, school, support payments		
Annual and irregular, one-twelfth (Worksheet 8)		
Total essentials (B)		

Wants (target about 30 per cent of A)	Tracked month	Plan
Eating out and takeaways		
Entertainment, streaming, subscriptions kept (Worksheet 4)		
Clothes and personal		
Hobbies, sport, gym		
Gifts and giving		
Spending money, adult 1 (no questions asked)		
Spending money, adult 2		
Other		
Total wants (C)		

Savings and extra debt (target about 20	Tracked month	Plan
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per cent of A)		
Starter fund (to \$1,000), then emergency fund		
Extra payment on the target debt (Worksheet 6)		
Retirement beyond payroll		
Total savings and extra debt (D)		

Check	
A minus B minus C minus D (should be zero or a small cushion)	
B as a percentage of A	
C as a percentage of A	
D as a percentage of A	

Worksheet 2 - The 30-Day Spending Tracker

Every purchase, every day, for one month. Change nothing. At the end, mark each line E (essential), W (want), S (savings or extra debt) or A (annual or irregular) and total the four.

Date	What	Amount	E / W / S / A

Totals for the month	Essentials	Wants	Savings	Annual	All

Worksheet 3 - The Debt Inventory

Debt (card, loan, plan, overdraft, family)	Balance	Interest rate (APR)	Minimum payment	Due day	Over 10 per cent?
Totals					

Total minimum payments (an essential in Worksheet 1)	
Total balance at over 10 per cent (the debt that goes first)	

Credit reports pulled from all three bureaus on	
Errors found and disputed on	
Credit score today (and the bureau)	

Worksheet 4 - The Subscription Audit

Every recurring charge from the tracking month and the last twelve months of statements (the annual ones hide).

Subscription or recurring charge	Monthly cost (annual divided by 12)	Last used	Keep / Cancel / Pause	Cancelled on (screenshot kept)	Renewal date

Total kept			Total cancelled (a month)		
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Worksheet 5 - The Emergency Fund Plan

Monthly essentials (B from Worksheet 1)	
Starter fund target	\$1,000
Full fund target: essentials x _____ months (3 for two stable incomes; 6 for one income or self-employed)	
High-yield savings account opened at (a different bank), on	
Automatic transfer on payday: \$_____ every _____	
Month the starter fund reaches \$1,000 (planned / actual)	
Month the full fund is reached at this rate (planned)	

Month	Deposits	Withdrawals (what for)	Balance
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			

Worksheet 6 - The Debt Payoff Plan

Method chosen: avalanche (highest rate first) / snowball (smallest balance first). Extra amount available each month (D from Worksheet 1, after the starter fund): \$_____

Order	Debt	Balance	Rate	Minimum	Extra this month	Paid off (month)
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						

When debt 1 is gone, its minimum plus the extra rolls onto debt 2. Write the running balances here each month:

Month	Debt 1	Debt 2	Debt 3	Debt 4	Total owed
1					
2					
3					
4					

5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					

Worksheet 7 - The Paycheck Plan (the automation, written down)

Payday: every _____ (date or weekday)	Amount
Take-home arriving	
Transfer to savings (emergency fund and sinking funds), set for the day after payday	
Transfer to the target debt (extra payment)	
Transfer to spending account, adult 1	
Transfer to spending account, adult 2	
Stays in the bills account for the direct debits	
Check: all of the above equals the take-home	

Bills paid automatically from the bills account	Amount	Day of month
Rent or mortgage		
Utilities		
Internet and phone		
Insurance		

Loan and card minimums		
Subscriptions kept		
Other		

Third paycheck in a month (fortnightly pay): goes in full to _____.

Worksheet 8 - The Annual Expenses Calendar and the Sinking Fund

From last year's statements: everything that is not monthly.

Month	Expense	Amount	Expense	Amount
January				
February				
March				
April				
May				
June				
July				
August				
September				
October				
November				
December				
Total for the year				

Total divided by 12 = the sinking-fund transfer each month (an essential in Worksheet 1)	
Sinking fund account or pot opened at, on	
Balance at the start of the year	

Worksheet 9 - Net Worth, Once a Year

What I own	Value	What I owe	Balance
Current and savings accounts		Mortgage	
Emergency and sinking funds		Car loan	
Retirement accounts		Cards	
Other investments		Student loans	
Home (what it would sell for)		Personal loans, buy-now-pay-later	
Car (what a dealer would pay)		Money owed to family, overdraft	
Other (cash value of life insurance, valuables)		Other	
Total owned		Total owed	

Year	Total owned	Total owed	Net worth	Change from last year
